

SPRING 2026 · SESSION 5 · ESU

Advanced Tools & The Future of AI in Higher Ed

A conversation about who we're becoming.

Facilitated by Fernando Alcántar · EdD Candidate: *"Ethical and Pedagogical Applications of AI"*

Four sessions. One foundation.

01

Foundations

What AI is, what it isn't

02

Prompting

The CRAFT framework

03

Classroom

NotebookLM in practice

04

Office Suite

Practical skills & data

Today we build perspective.

Tools without judgment is how institutions get blindsided.

THE QUESTION FOR TODAY

What does it mean to be an educator at a public regional university during a technological transition that may reorganize the relationship between labor, knowledge, and institutions?

We're not answering it today. We're earning the right to sit with it.

The economy is moving faster than our planning cycles.

~60%

of jobs in advanced economies
face meaningful AI exposure

IMF, 2024

14%

of the global workforce may need
to change careers by 2030

McKinsey

15.1%

of U.S. employment is already
≥50% automated (~23.2M jobs)

2026 data

These ranges are wide — and contested. That's the point. We're operating inside real uncertainty.

Our students are already making decisions.

42.5%

underemployment rate for young adults with college experience

Federal Reserve Bank of NY, Dec 2025

30%

of 2025 graduates secured full-time work in their field

Cengage 2025 Graduate Employability Report

16%

of enrolled students have already changed their major because of AI

Lumina–Gallup 2026 State of Higher Education

They're anxious. They're looking at us to help them make sense of it.

A P R I L 2 0 2 6

A frontier AI lab wrote a social contract.

Industrial Policy for the Intelligence Age

OpenAI · 13 pages · 16 proposals · Published April 2026

Let's read it together.

“ *These ideas are intentionally early and exploratory, offered not as a comprehensive or final set of recommendations, but as a starting point for discussion that we invite others to build on, refine, challenge, or choose among through the democratic process.*

— Industrial Policy for the Intelligence Age, p. 4

They're inviting us into the conversation. We'll take them at their word.

Three themes. Three questions. One hour.



Who gets access?

RIGHT TO AI

"Treat access to AI as foundational for participation in the modern economy, similar to mass efforts to increase global literacy, or to make sure that electricity and the internet reach remote parts of the globe."

p. 6

SCIENTIFIC DISCOVERY

"Both laboratory and production infrastructure should be deployed broadly across universities, community colleges, hospitals, and regional research hubs, not concentrated in a small number of elite institutions."

p. 8

DISCUSSION

If access to AI becomes a basic right, what is ESU's obligation — to our students, to our community, to people who never walk through our doors?



Who captures the value?

PUBLIC WEALTH FUND

"Create a Public Wealth Fund that provides every citizen — including those not invested in financial markets — with a stake in AI-driven economic growth."

p. 6

THE RISK THEY NAME THEMSELVES

"There is also a risk that the economic gains concentrate within a small number of firms like OpenAI, even as the technology itself becomes more powerful and widely used."

p. 4

DISCUSSION

A company preparing for an IPO is proposing every citizen should own a piece of AI's upside. Is that visionary, strategic, or both? Does it matter?



Who makes the rules?

MECHANISMS FOR PUBLIC INPUT

"Create structured ways for public input so that alignment isn't defined only by engineers or executives behind closed doors."

p. 11

WORKER PERSPECTIVES

"Workers have deep knowledge about how work is actually performed and where AI can improve outcomes. They will be critical voices..."

p. 5

DISCUSSION

Who in higher ed has deep knowledge about how work actually happens? Are those voices in the room when AI decisions get made at ESU?

Hold these two sentences next to each other.

THEIR STATED GOAL

"Avoiding a concentration of wealth and control will require ensuring that people everywhere can use AI..."

p. 3

THE RISK THEY ACKNOWLEDGE

"There is also a risk that the economic gains concentrate within a small number of firms like OpenAI..."

p. 4

Who is best positioned to prevent the concentration of AI power — the firms concentrating it, or the institutions educating the next generation of citizens?

So what does this mean for ESU?

Three open questions. Not answers.

01 What do our students need from us in the next four years that our current curriculum doesn't provide?

02 What does "AI literacy" mean for a graduate of a public regional university in 2030?

03 What is the civic function of a university in a technological transition it did not choose?

AFTER FIVE SESSIONS

3 Takeaways are...

- 1** AI fluency is necessary but not sufficient.
- 2** The most important skill is the one AI can't outsource: judgment.
- 3** Higher education's job is not to keep up with AI. It's to produce the people who will decide what AI is for.

Democratic processes require participation.



OpenAI is accepting public feedback on this document.

newindustrialpolicy@openai.com

A pilot program of fellowships and research grants (up to \$100,000 and \$1M in API credits) is available for work that builds on these proposals.

If something in this document moved you — agreement or disagreement — respond to it.

T H A N K Y O U

**For five sessions. For showing up
during a transition most are sleepwalking
through.**

That matters.

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